One Family Merry-Go-Round

How to feed past records and carry on every month

Before you start

The administrator does this once.

1. Sign in as the administrator. Under **Settings**, create the chairman's account.
2. In **Settings > Group settings**, fill in the advance interest rate, the standard registration fee and the **merry go round contribution per member**.
3. Fill in **Opening cash** (cash and bank the group holds at the month you start from) and **Interest pool brought in** (interest earned before that month and not yet shared). Save.

Part 1: Feeding past records

There are two ways. Pick one before you begin.

Option A: Start from now with each member's balances

Quick. Use it if you only need to know where every member stands today.

1. Open **Registration** and register every member. Under **Opening balances**, type the savings they already have and any advance they still owe. Leave these empty for a brand new member.
2. Open **Monthly records** and press **Start the books** with the current month.
3. Check that the **Brought forward** columns match your book. If a figure is wrong, correct it on the member's page under Opening balances. This is possible until the first month is rolled.

> With this option, months before your starting month, including who took the merry go round, will not be in the system.

Option B: Feed every past month

Takes longer. Use it if you want the full history, including who took the merry go round each month.

1. Register the members who were in the group in the first month of your book. Use Opening balances only for what they had **before** that month. Opening cash and the interest pool in Settings must also be the figures at that first month, not today's.
2. Open **Monthly records** and press **Start the books** with the first month in your book, for example January 2025.
3. For that month, choose who took the merry go round, then type each member's figures from the book. Press **Save all**.
4. Compare the totals row with the book. When they agree, press **Roll** to move to the next month.
5. Repeat month by month until you reach the current month.

- A member who joined later: register them when you reach the month they joined. They are added to the month that is open.
- Interest on advances is worked out by the system. If the group used a different rate in the past, set that rate in Settings before feeding those months.

- Rolled a month too early? The administrator can use **Undo last roll** in Settings, as long as nothing has been typed in the new month yet.

Part 2: Every month from now on

At or after each meeting:

1. Open **Monthly records**. It opens on the current month with balances and interest due already filled in.
2. In the merry go round bar, choose who takes it this month. Members who already took it this round are marked.
3. Press **Fill standard amount** to put the contribution in for everyone else. Change any member who gave less or nothing.
4. For each member, type the amount brought, advance repaid and any new advance.
5. Press **Save all**. A row in red has a problem; the reason is shown under the member's name.
6. Check the totals against the cash counted at the meeting.
7. Press **Roll** to lock the month and open the next one.

What goes in each column

Column	What to type
Amount brought	All the cash the member brought for the group, without the merry go round money. Interest is taken first, then the repayment, and the rest goes to savings.
Advance repaid	The part of the amount brought that pays back their advance.
Merry go round	What the member gave the person taking it this month.
New advance	Money given to the member as an advance this month.

Good to know

- **New member:** register them under Registration. They appear in the month that is open.
- **Member leaves:** open their page, press Edit details and set the status to Inactive.
- **Merry go round page:** shows who has taken it this round, who is still waiting, and every past month.
- **Bonus:** shared from interest of months that have been rolled.
- **Typing is kept on the phone or computer** until it is saved, so nothing is lost if the page closes.